



Division of Oil, Gas, and Geothermal Resources

Created by the Legislature in 1915, the Division of Oil, Gas, and Geothermal Resources (DOGGR) ensures the safe exploration and development of energy resources. It oversees the drilling, operation and closure of oil, gas, and geothermal wells – an important step in protecting public safety and protecting the environment. The Division also oversees enhanced recovery projects intended to maximize production from the state's oil reservoirs. DOGGR provides many other services including:

Well Records, Field Maps, and Production Statistics

DOGGR is the clearinghouse for information about the state's oil, natural gas, and geothermal industries. More than 190,000 well records, production and injection statistics, well logs and field

deteriorate and corrode, potentially becoming an environmental and safety concern. Usually, operators shut down wells properly under DOGGR supervision. A well is considered deserted when there is no one to take responsibility for plugging and abandoning it. In such cases, DOGGR steps in and does the work with industry-provided funds. DOGGR is authorized to spend up to \$2 million per year to plug deserted wells. To reduce the number of idle wells that may become orphaned, the Department of Conservation sponsored Assembly Bill 2729, which was signed by Governor Brown and will be implemented over the next several years. This measure establishes a new definition of "idle well," sets a fee structure intended to encourage operators to reduce their idle well inventory, and requires operators to develop an idle well management plan.

California Department of Conservation • 2018

Issue found

The legacy publication uses the former DOGGR division name. CalGEM replaced DOGGR effective January 1, 2020, so current-facing materials should use the current division identity.



California Geologic Energy Management Resource

Created by the Legislature in 1915, the California Geologic Energy Management Division's (CalGEM) ensures the safe exploration and development of energy resources. It oversees the drilling, operation and closure of oil, gas, and geothermal wells – an important step in protecting public safety and protecting the environment. The Division also oversees enhanced recovery projects intended to maximize production from the state's oil reservoirs. CalGEM provides many other services including:

Well Records, Field Maps, and Production Statistics

CalGEM is the clearinghouse for information about the state's oil, natural gas, and geothermal industries. More than 190,000 well records, production and injection statistics, well logs

deteriorate and corrode, potentially becoming an environmental and safety concern. Usually, operators shut down wells properly under CalGEM supervision. A well is considered deserted when there is no one to take responsibility for plugging and abandoning it. In such cases, CalGEM steps in and does the work with industry-provided funds.

CalGEM is authorized to spend up to \$12 million per year to plug deserted wells. To reduce the number of idle wells that may become orphaned, the Department of Conservation sponsored Assembly Bill 1234, which updated AB 2729 and will enhance the foundational efforts over the last several years. This measure establishes a new definition of "idle well," sets a new fee structure intended to encourage operators to reduce their idle well inventory, and requires operators to develop an idle well

Proposed modernization example

Proposed fix

Preserve the original subject matter while updating the division name, hierarchy, typography, and branding to match the current CalGEM standards.

1. Heading structure & scanability

Dense text and weak hierarchy can make legacy documents harder to scan, especially for users relying on clear section structure.



Proposed update

Use descriptive headings, shorter text blocks, consistent spacing, and more spacing between paragraphs and sections. Providing more white space makes it easier to read.

2. Contrast & visual communication

Older materials may use small text, low-contrast elements, or visual cues that depend too heavily on color alone.



Proposed update

Increase contrast, maintain readable type sizes, and pair color with labels, icons, or text.

3. Content currency

Legacy documents can retain old division names, links, contact information, program names, or terminology after organizational changes.



Proposed update

Add a routine currency check for agency name, links, contacts, dates, terminology, and superseded procedures.

Review approach

This prototype demonstrates a maintenance workflow: identify a legacy issue, document why it matters, propose a targeted update, and preserve the underlying substantive content. Accessibility observations shown here are a visual review, not a formal PDF/UA compliance determination.